

Richard Wooding

Staff Go Engineer · AI & MCP Tooling

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff engineer with **6+ years of Go** and **25+ years** of professional software development across product companies, startups, and consultancies. Deep focus on **AI tooling** and the **Model Context Protocol** — and a lifelong computer-language polyglot.

Idiomatic Go services, CLIs, and open-source libraries — with a strong focus on AI tooling and the Model Context Protocol. Comfortable across the full stack: comprehensive **React** experience on high-traffic consumer frontends, and comprehensive **AWS** and **Google Cloud** experience designing, deploying, and operating production systems on both. From enterprise Java origins to modern TypeScript and Python, and experienced in technical leadership, architecture, and shipping production systems for global clients.

EXPERIENCE

Staff Software Engineer · SPAN Digital Innovation

Aug 2022 – Present

Global software consultancy working with scaling start-ups and category-defining enterprises.

- Recognised as SPAN's internal **MCP expert** and an Extended Leadership Team member, shaping technical strategy and the open-source roadmap.
- Designed and built **feed-mcp** — an MCP server for RSS, Atom, and JSON feeds (Go; A+ Go Report Card, 15 GitHub stars).
- Built **duckdb-mcp**, exposing DuckDB analytical queries to LLM clients, and **mcp-server-dump**, a CLI for extracting and documenting MCP server capabilities.
- Delivered a talk at the Cape Town ML Meetup — *Developing a Specialised Business Assistant* (knowledge management, metadata, RAG).
- Drove AI-tooling adoption across client engagements, including LLM-powered document intelligence and internal knowledge-base systems.
- Led an audit of SPAN's GitHub presence and open-source contribution strategy.
- Designed, deployed, and operated client systems on **AWS** — the primary cloud across SPAN engagements.

Senior Software Engineer · SPAN Digital Innovation

Mar 2020 – Aug 2022

- Delivered software engineering across multiple client engagements; promoted to Staff Engineer after two and a half years.
- Worked across Go, TypeScript, and Python in a polyglot consultancy environment, shipping to **AWS**.

Senior Software Engineer II, Discovery Core Team · takealot.com

Jan 2016 – Mar 2020

South Africa's largest e-commerce platform.

- Part of the Discovery team responsible for product pages, search, and landing-page frontends — both API and UI layers, building the UI in **React**.
- Built and operated Discovery services on **Google Cloud**, and worked on takealot's transition to **Kubernetes**.
- Worked in a high-traffic, high-availability environment serving millions of South African shoppers.

Software Engineer · 42Engines

Dec 2014 – Dec 2015

- Dali platform engineer — moved the Dali platform forward across backend services.

Senior Software Architect · Double Eye / Map2Tech / PageMan

Mar 2011 – Nov 2014

- Responsible for software and information architecture across a diverse team of enterprise, web, and mobile developers.
- Founded and architected **PageMan** (2013–2014), a digital-signage platform based in Century City, Cape Town.
- Software polyglot — operated across multiple languages and paradigms depending on project needs.

- Software architecture for enterprise Java, web, and mobile development teams over five years.

Earlier career

2000 – 2010

Chesscube (contractor, 2009–2010): Java and ActionScript, Facebook integration, and virtual currencies for the online chess platform. **Camara Consulting** (2000–2006): six years specialising in enterprise Java, SQL, and PL/SQL with extensive financial-systems work.

OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

feed-mcp github.com/richardwooding/feed-mcp

MCP server for RSS, Atom, and JSON feeds. Supports stdio, Streamable HTTP, and Docker. A+ Go Report Card, 15★.

duckdb-mcp github.com/richardwooding/duckdb-mcp

MCP server for DuckDB — lets LLMs query analytical data directly in a conversation.

mcp-server-dump github.com/richardwooding/mcp-server-dump

CLI that extracts and documents MCP server capabilities — improving DX across the MCP ecosystem.

powerdown github.com/richardwooding/powerdown

CLI for the EskomSePush API — load-shedding intelligence for South African developers.

Game of Life (WASM) github.com/richardwooding/gameoflife

Conway's Game of Life as a Progressive Web App — Go compiled to WebAssembly.

NostalgizA github.com/richardwooding/nostalgizA

Game Boy emulator written in Go — retro-gaming nostalgia with a South African identity.

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Go · primary · TypeScript · Python · Java · C# · SQL / PL/SQL · Afrikaans · native · English · native

AI / LLM: Model Context Protocol · RAG · LLM integration · Prompt engineering

Cloud & infrastructure: AWS · Google Cloud · Docker · Kubernetes · CI/CD · REST APIs · gRPC

Frontend: React · TypeScript · HTML / CSS · WebAssembly

Data: DuckDB · SQL / PL/SQL · JSON / Atom / RSS

Practices: Technical leadership · Open-source authorship · Architecture reviews · Mentoring

SPEAKING

Cape Town ML Meetup

Developing a Specialised Business Assistant — knowledge management, metadata, and RAG. Hosted at SPAN Digital, Cape Town.

EDUCATION

University of Cape Town

1998

Knysna High School

1996 – 1997

Grey High School · [Port Elizabeth](#)

1992 – 1996